

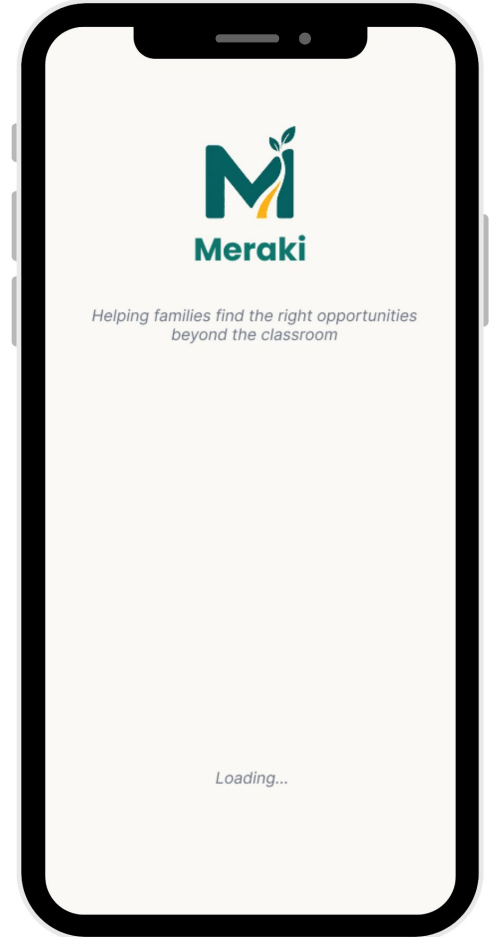


MERAKI

*Helping Families Find the Right
Opportunities Beyond the Classroom*

UX Case Study

Shivani S



PROJECT OVERVIEW



Meraki is a mobile platform that helps parents and guardians discover, evaluate, and enroll their children in after-school programs. The app streamlines the entire journey through location-based recommendations, program details, visit booking, enrollment, and payment management, enabling families to make informed and confident decisions about their children's learning opportunities.

Target Users: Parents, guardians, and caregivers

Goal: To simplify access to quality after-school programs while providing a seamless, accessible, and user-centered experience

PROBLEM STATEMENT



Parents need an easier way to discover and enroll their children in suitable after-school programs because existing solutions require searching across multiple sources and often lack information about accessibility, schedules, and program suitability.

MY ROLE



Role: UX Designer

Responsibilities: Research, Information Architecture, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, UI Design, Testing, and Iteration.

Ownership: Sole designer throughout the project lifecycle.

TARGET USERS



Primary Users

- Parents and guardians searching for after-school programs for their children.
- Families managing multiple children with different interests, schedules, and needs.

User Groups Identified

- Urban parents seeking convenience and quality programs.
- Semi-urban parents balancing accessibility and affordability.
- Rural parents looking for reliable and trustworthy learning opportunities.

DESIGN DECISION 01 : IMPROVING PROGRAM DISCOVERY

Research Insight

Parents often struggle to find and compare suitable after-school programs.

Design Decision

Added location based recommendations, search, and advanced filters to help parents discover relevant programs more easily.

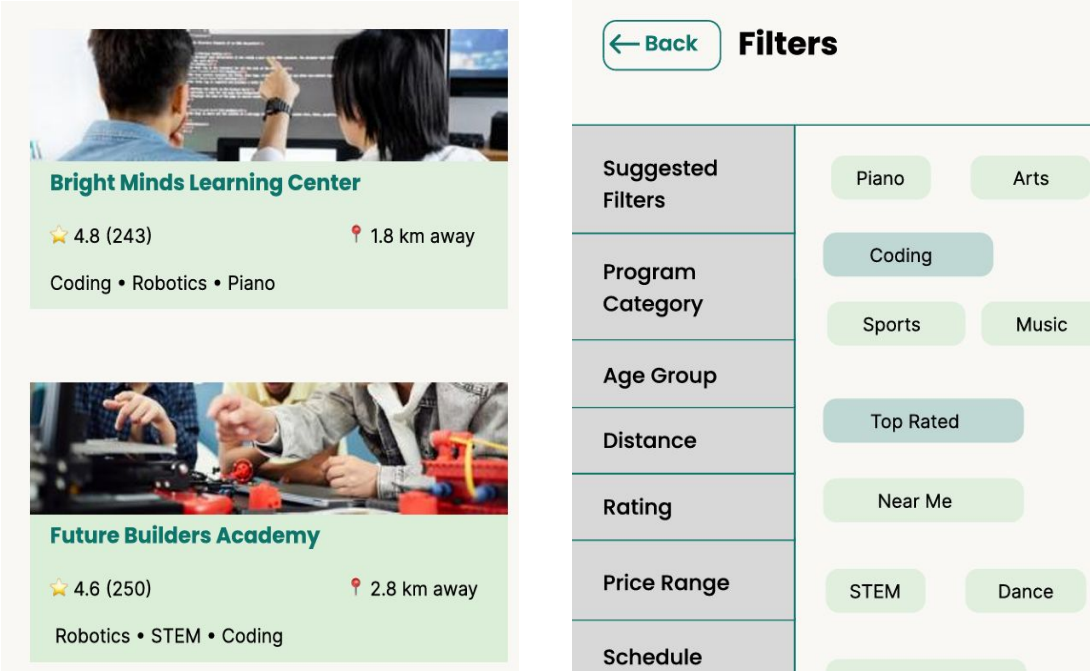


Fig 1: Simplified program discovery through location-based recommendations and advanced filtering.

DESIGN DECISION 02 : SUPPORTING INFORMED DECISIONS

Research Insight

Parents require detailed information about programs, facilities, schedules, pricing, and reviews before committing to an enrollment decision.

Design Decision

Created comprehensive center profiles containing program details, facilities, accessibility information, ratings, reviews, travel information, and enrollment options.

Bright Minds Learning Center

★ 4.8 (243 Reviews)

 Wheelchair Accessible

 School Pickup Available

 Background Checked Staff

 Accessible Restrooms

Categories: STEM,Music,Arts

 1.8 km away

 8 min drive

 10 min cycling

 22 min walk

 15 min by bus

[Get Directions](#)

Parent Reviews

★★★★★
"My daughter absolutely loves the robotics classes. The instructors are patient and encourage creativity."
— Priya M.

★★★★★
"The center has been incredibly accommodating for my son who uses a wheelchair."
— Anita K.

Fig 2: Key information including ratings, facilities, accessibility features, travel distance, estimated travel times, directions, and parent reviews is available directly within the center profile.

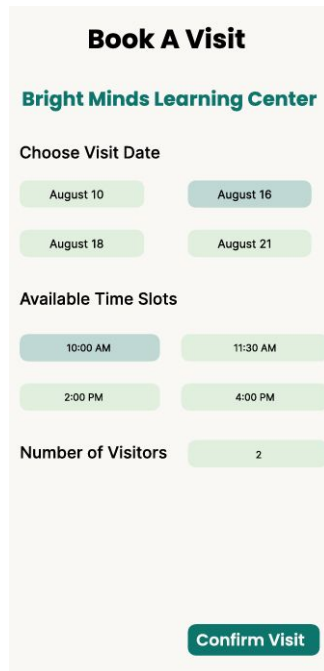
DESIGN DECISION 03 : TRUST BEFORE ENROLLMENT

Research Insight

Research indicated that parents prefer evaluating a center before making a commitment and seek reassurance regarding program quality and environment.

Design Decision

Introduced a visit-booking feature that allows parents to schedule and attend a center visit before enrolling their child.



Book A Visit

Bright Minds Learning Center

Choose Visit Date

August 10 August 16

August 18 August 21

Available Time Slots

10:00 AM 11:30 AM

2:00 PM 4:00 PM

Number of Visitors 2

Confirm Visit



Upcoming Visits

Creative Sparks Studio

August 20, 2026

10:00 AM

Fig 3: The visit-booking feature allows parents to explore centers firsthand before committing to a program.

DESIGN DECISION 04 : SIMPLIFYING ENROLLMENT



Research Insight

Parents need a convenient way to manage enrollments, child information, schedules, and special requirements without repeating information across multiple forms.

Design Decision

Designed child profiles with support for allergies, accessibility requirements, and additional notes, while streamlining the enrollment process into a single flow.

Allergies (if any)

Mild peanut allergy. Please avoid snacks containing peanuts or peanut products.

Accessibility needs

No accessibility accommodations required.

Additional information

Prefers smaller group activities and additional time when adjusting to new environments.

Latest Updates

Bright Minds Learning Center

Robotics class will begin 30 minutes later on Friday.

2 hours ago

Creative Sparks Studio

Students should bring watercolor supplies tomorrow.

Yesterday

Future Builders Academy

Payment reminder: Monthly fee due on Aug 30.

1 week ago

Fig 4: Child-specific requirements and important updates are managed in one place, creating a more personalized enrollment experience.

DESIGN DECISION 05 : DESIGNING FOR ACCESSIBILITY

Research Insight

Some families need programs that can accommodate accessibility requirements and special needs, but this information is often difficult to find.

Design Decision

Integrated accessibility filters and detailed accessibility information throughout the platform to help families identify suitable programs more confidently

Accessibility

- Wheelchair Accessible Entrance
- Ramp Access
- Accessible Restrooms
- Special Needs Support
- Sensory-Friendly Learning Spaces



"The center has been incredibly accommodating for my son who uses a wheelchair."

— Anita K.

Fig 5: Transparent accessibility details and authentic parent feedback support informed decision-making.

RESEARCH & INSIGHTS



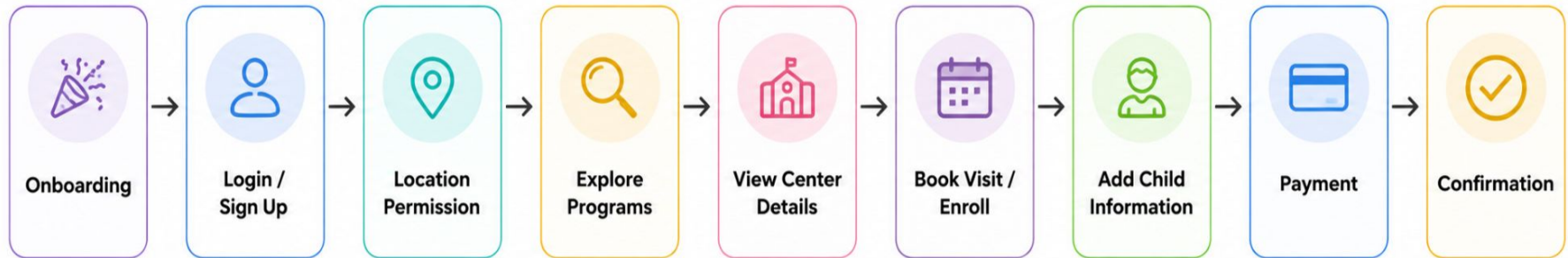
Key Findings

- Users found navigation generally easy to use.
- Calendar and Notes sections caused confusion.
- Users wanted onboarding and clearer app purpose.
- Parents needed more information to compare programs.
- Location alone was not enough for decision-making.

Design Improvements

- Introduced onboarding.
- Redesigned navigation.
- Added filters and detailed center information.
- Created complete authentication flow.
- Improved transparency and accessibility features.

USER JOURNEY





PROTOTYPE WALKTHROUGH

The interactive prototype demonstrates the complete enrollment journey from discovery to confirmation.



REFLECTION & NEXT STEPS



Reflections

- This project strengthened my understanding of user-centered design, usability testing, and high-fidelity prototyping.
- User feedback played a key role in refining navigation, improving clarity, and enhancing the overall user experience.
- Designing Meraki highlighted the importance of accessibility, transparency, and informed decision-making in educational platforms.

Next Steps

- Conduct additional usability testing with parents and guardians.
- Expand features such as center-parent communication and progress tracking.
- Improve personalization through smarter recommendations and scheduling options.
- Continue iterating the design based on user feedback and real-world needs.



Thank You

Feedback Form :

<https://forms.gle/MuAXzcMaiZ4mFTbE6>

Share your feedback to help improve future iterations of Meraki.



This project was completed as part of the Google UX Design Professional Certificate, demonstrating the application of UX research, wireframing, prototyping, usability testing, and high-fidelity design principles.